



MODULE 0 + MODULE 1

# Foundations

The job, the freight world  
and your seat in it

What a carrier-side dispatcher really does, how you can do it from Pakistan with only a laptop and a phone, who everyone in a load is, how one real load moves from posting to payment, and where the legal line between dispatcher and broker sits.

**5**  
lessons

**1 real load**  
followed end to end

**~7 hours**  
study + practice

**60+**  
checks with answers

# How to use this handbook

You are learning a job, not a subject. Every page is built around one question: **what would a carrier-side dispatcher actually see, decide or say here?**

## Study rhythm (about 7 hours)

- **Session 1 (2 h):** Module 0 — the job, your setup, your hours, the job market.
- **Session 2 (2.5 h):** Lesson 1.1 — the players and the real load #12354. Study the three documents slowly.
- **Session 3 (1.5 h):** Lessons 1.2 and 1.3 — daily work and the broker line.
- **Session 4 (1 h):** All checks, the speaking drills, then the answer key. Redo anything under 80%.

## Use it with the slide deck

The PowerPoint for this module shows the same pictures, big. Read the handbook first, then flip through the deck the next day as a fast review. Before the next module, try to explain each slide out loud without reading.

## How to read the icons



### Dispatcher rule

A habit that separates good dispatchers from risky ones.



### Watch out

Common mistakes, myths and outdated advice.



### Real world

From real documents, real job ads, real data.



### Say it out loud

Short speaking drills. Say them aloud — really.



### Check yourself

Questions. Answers at the back.

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# 0

## MODULE 0 · ORIENTATION

# From Pakistan to a U.S. carrier desk

### In this module

**L0.1** What the job is — and what it is not

**L0.2** Your zero-investment operating setup

Your hours in Pakistan time · the real job market · the course route

### After it you can

- Explain the dispatcher's job in two sentences
- Say what you own vs what the carrier supplies
- Convert U.S. office hours into Pakistan time
- Describe a realistic way into your first job

# One message defines the whole job

It is 9:30 PM in Lahore. A text arrives from a small trucking company in Illinois:

WhatsApp • Mike (owner, 3 trucks) • 12:30 PM Central

Truck 12 empties in **Joliet, IL tomorrow 7:30 AM**. 53' dry van. Driver Carlos will have his full 11 hours of driving tomorrow. We want to go toward the Southeast, need **\$2.40+/mile**. Find me something good.

Your answer — by the end of this course:

Booked: Joliet → Charlotte, NC, 750 mi, \$2,050. Broker verified, RC checked. PU Wed 9 AM, DEL Thu 2 PM. Directions + PU# sent to Carlos.

To send that answer you must have done **all of this**, in about an hour:

- **Equipment:** which loads fit a 53' dry van — and which don't.
- **Geography & time:** where Joliet and Charlotte are, and what 7:30 AM Central is in Pakistan.
- **Hours of service:** can Carlos legally pick up and deliver on time?
- **Load board:** search smartly and shortlist loads.
- **Economics:** is \$2,050 for 750 miles, plus empty miles, good for this truck?
- **Broker checks:** is this broker real, authorized, and good at paying?
- **Negotiation:** ask the right questions, then get a better rate.
- **Paperwork:** read the rate confirmation before the carrier signs.
- **Execution:** dispatch the driver and handle what goes wrong.



## This is the whole course in one message

Each item on the right is a module. Nothing here is theory for its own sake: every page exists so you can answer a message like Mike's correctly, safely and fast. Keep this page in mind — we return to Joliet in the final simulation.



Your seat: a Pakistan-based dispatcher's desk. Load board, email and maps on screen, a headset for brokers, a phone for drivers — and U.S. time on the wall.

# What a carrier-side dispatcher does



## Working definition

A truck dispatcher works **for a motor carrier**. The job is to **keep the carrier's trucks loaded with profitable, legal freight**: find loads, check the broker, negotiate, book, send the driver, follow the load until it is delivered, and close the paperwork so the carrier gets paid.



The dispatcher's loop. It starts with an empty truck and ends with the next empty truck — several times a day, for every truck you run.

## The dispatcher's three customers

**The carrier (owner)** pays you and wants profit. **The driver** is your daily partner: they want good miles, home time and clear information. **The broker** is who you buy freight from. You are polite and professional with brokers, but you do not work for them.

## What "good" looks like

A good dispatcher keeps empty miles low and pay per mile high. They avoid fraud and never book a load the driver can't legally make. Drivers trust what they say, and the paperwork is clean enough that the carrier is paid on time.



## Carrier-side means carrier-side

In every conversation, ask: **"Is this good for my carrier and my driver?"** Not: "Will this make the broker happy?" Brokers negotiate for their margin. You negotiate for your truck.

## Eight words you will hear every day

### Load

One shipment you move for pay.

### Lane

A route between two areas, e.g. Chicago → Atlanta.

### Deadhead

Empty miles driven to reach a pickup. Unpaid.

### RPM

Rate per mile:  $\text{pay} \div \text{miles}$ .

### Broker

Middleman between shipper and carrier.

### RC

Rate confirmation: the load contract.

### BOL

Bill of lading: freight receipt, signed at pickup.

### POD

Proof of delivery: BOL signed by the receiver.

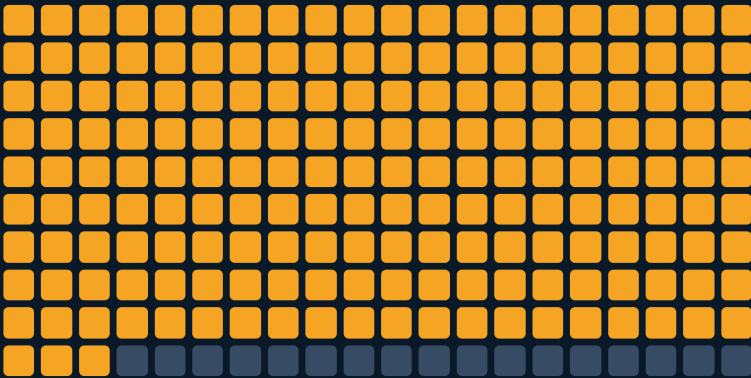
# Why small carriers pay for dispatch

91.5%

of U.S. carriers run 10 or fewer trucks

A small owner can't drive, search loads, call brokers and do paperwork at the same time. That gap is your job.

Source: ATA American Trucking Trends 2025 (2024 data)



## The owner-operator problem

Picture Carlos, who owns one truck. While he drives 10 hours a day, loads for tomorrow are posted and taken by other trucks within minutes. He can't search a load board or call five brokers while driving, and hours-of-service rules limit how long he can work anyway. Every day his truck sits empty, he still pays for the truck, the insurance and his own living costs.

A dispatcher solves exactly this problem. **The carrier drives; the dispatcher plans, sells and handles the paperwork.**

## Who hires dispatchers

| Employer                                                                      | What it looks like                                                                  |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Dispatch company</b><br>(often U.S.-registered with an office in Pakistan) | Runs many small carriers for a fee. The most common door for Pakistani dispatchers. |
| <b>Owner-operator / small fleet</b>                                           | 1–10 trucks, hires one dispatcher directly. Usually after you have experience.      |
| <b>Mid-size fleet</b>                                                         | In-house dispatch team; sometimes remote assistants for night or overflow work.     |



### The data

Trucks moved **11.27 billion tons** of U.S. freight in 2024, and the industry earned **\$906 billion** in revenue with **3.58 million** professional drivers. (ATA American Trucking Trends 2025.) Most of that capacity sits with small companies — your future clients.



**Owner-operator, 53' dry van** — the most common client



**Box-truck carrier** — local and regional, lots of small loads



**Power only** — tractor pulls someone else's trailer

# Six things this job is not

Most bad advice about dispatching comes from mixing it up with one of these.

## Not a broker

Brokers sell freight to shippers and buy trucks. You work for the truck. Crossing this line without broker authority is illegal — Lesson 1.3.

## Not a driver

You never touch the freight. But you must understand the driver's day, hours and equipment better than most drivers expect.

## Not a sales job to shippers

You don't contact factories for freight. Carrier-side dispatchers get loads from brokers and load boards.

## Not a call-center script

Every call needs decisions: is this load feasible, profitable and safe? A script alone gets you scammed.

## Not "get rich quick"

Ads that promise \$5,000/month from home in 30 days sell courses. Real pay grows with experience and results.

## Not borrowing logins

Using someone else's load-board password is against the rules and a fraud red flag. Access comes from the carrier or employer.

## Myth vs reality

| What you may hear                                                         | What is actually true                                                                                                                                                 |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| "You need a U.S. LLC, a website and a DAT subscription before you start." | Not for the starting route. You can work under a carrier or dispatch company that gives you authorized access. Buy tools only when a real business model needs them.  |
| "Dispatchers need a license."                                             | There is no federal "dispatcher license." But if you act like a broker, you need broker registration. DAT itself says the answer depends on the services you provide. |
| "Just book the highest rate on the board."                                | The highest rate can end in a dead market, need too many empty miles, or be fraud bait. Rate is one input of many (Module 7).                                         |
| "Old code sheets and rules from a PDF are enough."                        | Platforms and rules change. This course corrects outdated claims, for example about HOS, payload limits, CDL rules and load-board codes.                              |
| "Freshers get hired easily."                                              | Most Lahore job ads in 2026 ask for 6–12 months of experience. You need a plan to get in (Lesson 0.2).                                                                |

# What you bring, what the carrier brings

“Zero investment” doesn’t mean nobody pays for anything. It means **the carrier or employer already pays for the trucking infrastructure**, and you bring skill, time and a working desk.

### You bring

Already on your desk



**Laptop**  
Load board, email, maps



**Phone + WhatsApp**  
Drivers text and call



**Internet + backup**  
Fiber + mobile data



**Headset + quiet room**  
Brokers must hear you clearly

### The carrier / employer brings

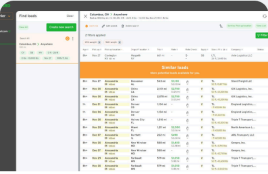
You never buy these to start



**Truck + trailer**  
The physical asset



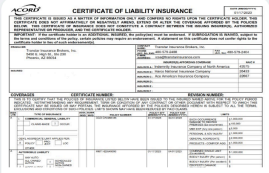
**Operating authority**  
USDOT / MC — permission to haul for hire



**Load-board seat**  
Carrier adds you to its account



**ELD + tracking**  
Driver hours & location



**Insurance (COI)**  
Brokers require it before booking

**Cost to you: PKR 0**  
You bring skill. The carrier or employer brings the trucking infrastructure.

The carrier side of the picture uses real documents from your training manuals: an FMCSA authority certificate, a certificate of insurance, an ELD device and a load-board screen.

## Your minimum desk, honestly

- **Laptop** that can run a browser with 10+ tabs, and a second screen if possible.
- **Internet with a backup.** A broker won’t wait while your connection drops. Keep mobile data ready.
- **Power backup (UPS)** for load-shedding. Budget for this one first.
- **Headset with a good mic** and a quiet corner. Clear sound matters more than accent.
- **Phone with WhatsApp**, because many U.S. drivers text.

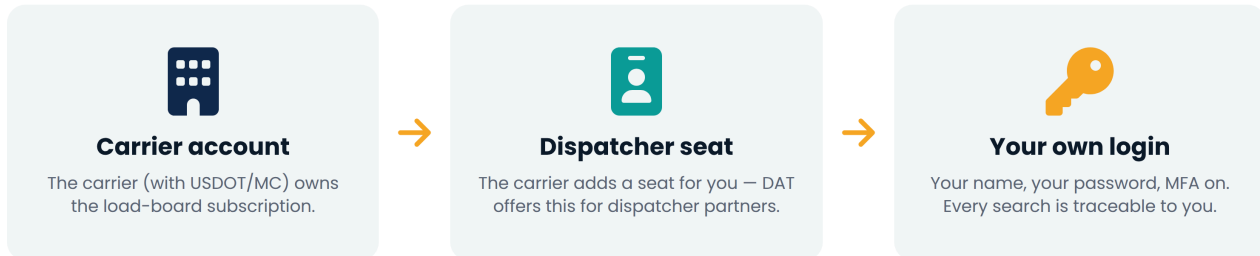
## Why the carrier’s things matter to you

**Authority (USDOT/MC)** is what makes a carrier legal to haul for hire. Brokers check it before they book. **Insurance** must be active, or no broker will give the load. The **ELD** records the driver’s hours, which decides what loads are legal to take. The **load-board seat** is where you find freight.

Registration is changing: FMCSA’s new Motus system (2025–26) changes how USDOT and MC (“docket”) numbers are issued and displayed. MC numbers are still on documents and load boards. Module 5 covers this in detail.

# How you get on a load board without paying

## How you get load-board access without paying



**Never log in with someone else's shared username and password. It breaks platform rules and is a classic fraud/identity-theft pattern.**

### The carrier-seat model

DAT, the largest U.S. load board, says it plainly: **"carriers with authority (MC/DOT) can add a seat to their account for their dispatcher partner."** In practice, your employer or carrier gives you a login under their account. You search and book **for them**, in their name.

Setting up as an independent third-party dispatcher with your own account comes later, and it has more requirements and costs. That is a business decision for after you have experience (Module 11).

### Account security from day one

- Use **your own** username, never a shared one.
- Turn on **MFA** (two-step login). Truckstop now makes MFA part of carrier onboarding.
- Never share one-time codes. A caller asking for your "verification code" is a scammer.
- Log out on shared computers. Don't save passwords in a browser at an office PC.
- A stolen dispatcher login is how fraudsters book loads in a real carrier's name.



### Why this is serious

FMCSA publishes warnings about broker and carrier **identity theft**: criminals use stolen accounts, look-alike emails and fake phone numbers to steal freight. Protecting your login protects your carrier's identity. Module 8 goes deep on fraud.

# Eight things not to buy yet

Every one of these is sold hard to beginners online. For the starting route, all of them are either unnecessary or someone else's cost.



## Load-board subscription

**Why not now:** The carrier or employer gives you a seat.

**Maybe later if:** You run your own dispatch business with signed carriers



## U.S. LLC / company

**Why not now:** You work under an existing company first.

**Maybe later if:** You have carriers and understand the legal setup



## Website & branding

**Why not now:** Nobody books loads because of your logo.

**Maybe later if:** You market to carriers at scale



## Paid dialer / VoIP

**Why not now:** Your employer provides phones and numbers.

**Maybe later if:** You need U.S. numbers for your own business



## Expensive "job-guarantee" course

**Why not now:** This course + practice + a portfolio does the job.

**Maybe later if:** Never — be very wary of guarantees



## Broker authority

**Why not now:** That is a different business with bonds and liability.

**Maybe later if:** Only if you deliberately choose brokerage



## CRM / lead lists

**Why not now:** You aren't selling to carriers yet.

**Maybe later if:** You start finding your own carrier clients



## Paid ads

**Why not now:** Nothing to advertise at the learning stage.

**Maybe later if:** After you have a proven service



## The rule

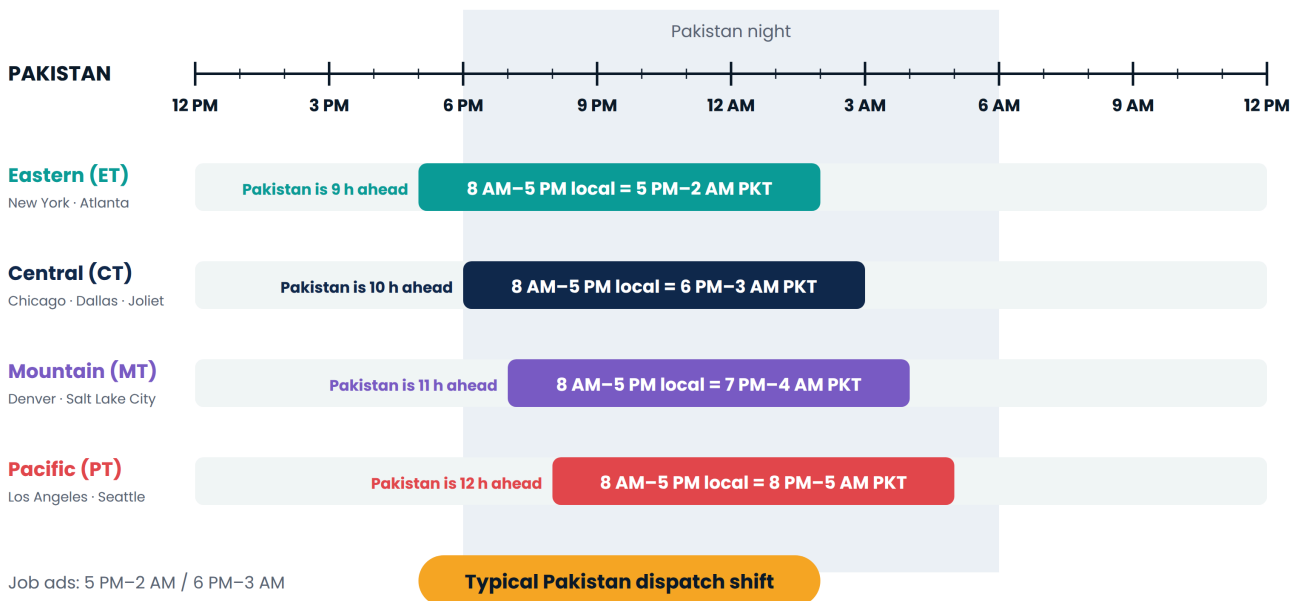
**Buy a tool only when a real job, carrier or client needs it**, and preferably when someone else is paying. Your first investments are skill, a UPS, a headset and time.

# You work while Pakistan sleeps

U.S. shippers, brokers and drivers work U.S. daytime. That is Pakistan evening and night. Pakistan (UTC+5) never changes its clocks, but the U.S. does twice a year, so your shift moves by one hour.

## When U.S. offices are open — in Pakistan time

U.S. daylight saving time • 8 Mar – 1 Nov 2026. Pakistan (PKT) never changes its clocks.



Right now (September 2026) the U.S. is on daylight saving time. Eastern offices open at 5 PM in Pakistan.

## The four zones you need

| Zone                 | Summer gap<br>Mar–Nov | Winter gap<br>Nov–Mar |
|----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|
| <b>Eastern (ET)</b>  | PKT = ET + 9 h        | PKT = ET + 10 h       |
| <b>Central (CT)</b>  | PKT = CT + 10 h       | PKT = CT + 11 h       |
| <b>Mountain (MT)</b> | PKT = MT + 11 h       | PKT = MT + 12 h       |
| <b>Pacific (PT)</b>  | PKT = PT + 12 h       | PKT = PT + 13 h       |

Most of Arizona does not use daylight saving time, so it stays at PKT = AZ + 12 h all year. Module 3 covers the exceptions.

## 2026–27 dates to remember

- Sun 1 Nov 2026:** U.S. clocks go back. Your shift starts an hour later.
- Sun 14 Mar 2027:** U.S. clocks go forward. Your shift starts an hour earlier.



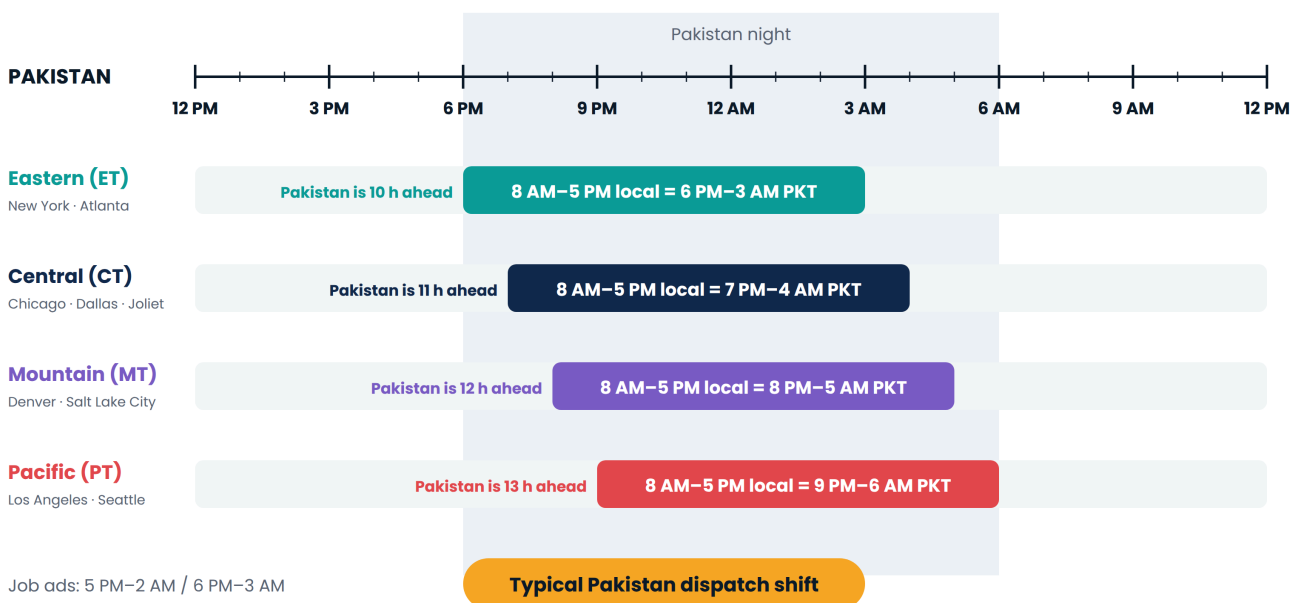
### Try it now

A broker says: "Pickup is 6 AM Central on Tuesday." Today is 30 September. What time is that in Pakistan, and on which day? (Answer at the back.)

# After 1 November: the winter shift

## When U.S. offices are open — in Pakistan time

U.S. standard time • 1 Nov 2026 – 14 Mar 2027. Pakistan (PKT) never changes its clocks.



From 1 Nov 2026 to 14 Mar 2027 every U.S. zone is one more hour behind Pakistan. Eastern offices open at 6 PM PKT.

## What the night really looks like

Shippers and receivers often start **earlier than offices**. Docks can open at 5–6 AM local time, and drivers are on the road even earlier. West Coast brokers are still working at 4–5 AM in Pakistan. Many Pakistani dispatch offices therefore run a **5 PM–2 AM or 6 PM–3 AM** shift and have someone watch late problems.

## Make the night sustainable

- Keep one fixed sleep block, for example 5 AM–12 PM, blackout curtains included.
- Eat a proper meal before your shift, not at 3 AM.
- Keep a U.S. clock strip on your screen (ET/CT/MT/PT).
- Protect Friday night: it is U.S. Friday, one of the busiest days.

## Quick converter (winter)

| U.S. local | ET → PKT | CT → PKT | PT → PKT |
|------------|----------|----------|----------|
| 6 AM       | 4 PM     | 5 PM     | 7 PM     |
| 8 AM       | 6 PM     | 7 PM     | 9 PM     |
| 10 AM      | 8 PM     | 9 PM     | 11 PM    |
| 12 PM      | 10 PM    | 11 PM    | 1 AM*    |
| 3 PM       | 1 AM*    | 2 AM*    | 4 AM*    |
| 5 PM       | 3 AM*    | 4 AM*    | 6 AM*    |

\* = next calendar day in Pakistan. A load that picks up "Monday 3 PM ET" is **Tuesday 1 AM** for you. Always write both dates.



### Write every time with its zone

Never write "pickup 8:00." Write **"PU Tue 8:00 AM CT (Tue 7 PM PKT)"**. Most expensive dispatch mistakes start with a missing time zone.

# What Pakistani employers actually ask for

A snapshot of real truck-dispatcher job ads on Indeed Pakistan in September 2026, most of them in Lahore. Salaries and ads change constantly; treat this as a picture of the market, not a promise.

| Employer (as advertised) | City   | Pay shown                                 | Experience asked | Shift / notes                |
|--------------------------|--------|-------------------------------------------|------------------|------------------------------|
| Astral Logistics         | Lahore | PKR 40–60k + 10% commission (up to ~180k) | 1 year           | On-site                      |
| I Tech                   | Lahore | PKR 65–80k + commission                   | 8 months         | 5 PM–2 AM; DAT/Truckstop     |
| Meratix Global           | Lahore | PKR 80–100k                               | Not stated       | —                            |
| AAA Digital              | Lahore | Not shown                                 | —                | Mon–Fri 6 PM–3 AM            |
| Lynx Logistics           | Lahore | Not shown                                 | 6–12 months      | Booking + negotiation        |
| The Digital Penguin      | Remote | Not shown                                 | “Preferred”      | Dispatch + driver onboarding |

## 6–12

**months’ experience** is the most common requirement. Very few ads say “freshers welcome.”

## Night

**5 PM–2 AM or 6 PM–3 AM**, usually on-site, sometimes hybrid or remote.

## Skills

**English negotiation, DAT/Truckstop, booking, driver coordination, tracking.**



### What this means for you

Experience is the gate, so your plan has to produce **evidence of skill** before you have a job title. This course is built to give you that evidence: recorded mock broker calls, a completed simulation log, and documents you have reviewed correctly. The next page shows how to use it.

# Three realistic doors into your first job

## Door 1 • Entry roles

Ads where experience is “preferred,” not required. Also **dispatch assistant**, **driver onboarding** or **carrier sales** roles at dispatch companies. You learn the live systems there, then move to a dispatch seat.

## Door 2 • Prove it in the interview

Many companies test you with a **mock broker call** and questions about load boards and documents. If you can run a clean call and read a rate confirmation, you stand out against people who only watched videos.

## Door 3 • Direct carrier (later)

After 6–12 months you can dispatch directly for owner-operators, as a contractor paid by the carrier. That is where your own business model begins (Module 11).

## Your portfolio: what you will build during this course

| Evidence                                                  | Built in                                 | Why it helps                                                  |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>3 recorded mock broker calls</b>                       | Modules 8 and 11 (role-play with Claude) | Shows clear English, the right questions and calm negotiation |
| <b>A reviewed rate confirmation</b> with problems marked  | Modules 1 and 9                          | Proves document literacy on day one                           |
| <b>A load comparison</b> with deadhead, RPM and HOS check | Modules 4 and 7                          | Shows you think beyond the posted rate                        |
| <b>A full simulated shift log</b>                         | Module 11                                | Shows the whole workflow, start to finish                     |
| <b>Fraud-check examples</b>                               | Module 8                                 | Employers fear double-brokering and identity theft            |



### Apply earlier than you think

Once you finish Module 8 (brokers and negotiation), start applying to entry roles while you finish Modules 9–11. The first job is also training.

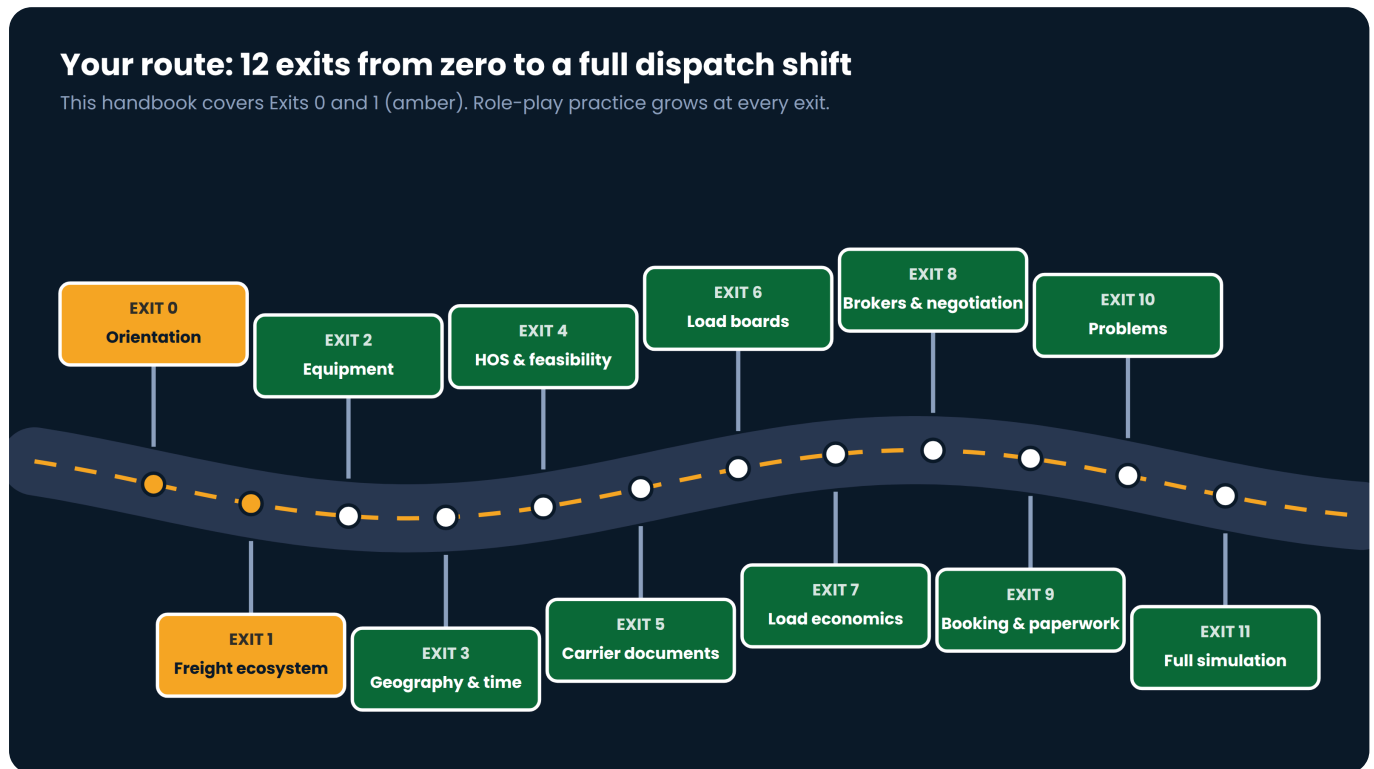


### Scams aimed at trainees

Be careful with “pay for training, job guaranteed” offers, unpaid “trial weeks” that last months, and anyone who asks you to use their DAT login or receive broker payments. Walk away.

# Twelve exits from zero to a full dispatch shift

The course follows the order you need things on a real desk. You can't judge a rate before you know the equipment, the geography and the driver's hours.



| Exit | Module                                 | The question it answers                                      |
|------|----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| 0–1  | Orientation · Freight ecosystem        | What is the job, who is who, where is the legal line?        |
| 2    | Equipment                              | Does this load physically fit this truck?                    |
| 3–4  | Geography & time · HOS & feasibility   | Where is it, when is it, and can the driver legally make it? |
| 5    | Carrier documents                      | Is my carrier set up and legal to haul for this broker?      |
| 6–7  | Load boards · Load economics           | Which loads exist, and which one is actually the best?       |
| 8    | Brokers, fraud, negotiation            | Is this broker real, and how do I get a better rate?         |
| 9–10 | Booking & paperwork · Problems         | How do I run the load and handle what goes wrong?            |
| 11   | Pakistan remote work + full simulation | Can I run a full shift, and how do I get hired?              |

# Module 0 check

Answer on paper first, then compare with the answer key. Aim for 8 out of 10.

1. In one sentence: who does a carrier-side dispatcher work for, and what is their main goal?
2. Name three things the carrier supplies that you should **not** buy at the start.
3. A friend offers you his DAT username and password “so you can practice.” What do you say, and why?
4. It is October. An Atlanta, GA broker says “call me back at 2 PM.” What time is that in Pakistan?
5. It is January. A Los Angeles receiver opens at 7 AM. What time is that in Pakistan?
6. Why do small carriers (the 91.5%) need dispatchers?
7. True or false: “There is a federal dispatcher license you must get first.” Explain.
8. The best-paying load on the board goes to a city where trucks rarely find a next load. Is it automatically the best choice? Why?
9. What is the most common barrier in Pakistani dispatch job ads, and what is your plan to get past it?
10. Write a pickup time correctly for your notes: pickup is Thursday 9 AM Central, in summer.



## Say it out loud — drill 1: introduce yourself

Say this five times, then record yourself on your phone and listen back. Speak slowly and clearly.

**“Hi, this is Jawad, dispatcher with Blue Line Transport, MC number 1-2-3-4-5-6. I’m calling about your load from Joliet, Illinois to Charlotte, North Carolina. Is it still available?”**

Then change the city pair to: Dallas, TX → Atlanta, GA and Lebanon, OH → Owensboro, KY. (Blue Line Transport is a practice carrier used throughout this course.)



## What a broker listens for in those 10 seconds

Your **name**, your **carrier and MC number** (so they can check you), and **which load**, by city pair. Clear, short and confident. Don’t say “sir” in every sentence, and don’t start by asking the rate.



## MODULE 1 • FREIGHT ECOSYSTEM

# Who is who, how a load moves, and where your job ends

### In this module

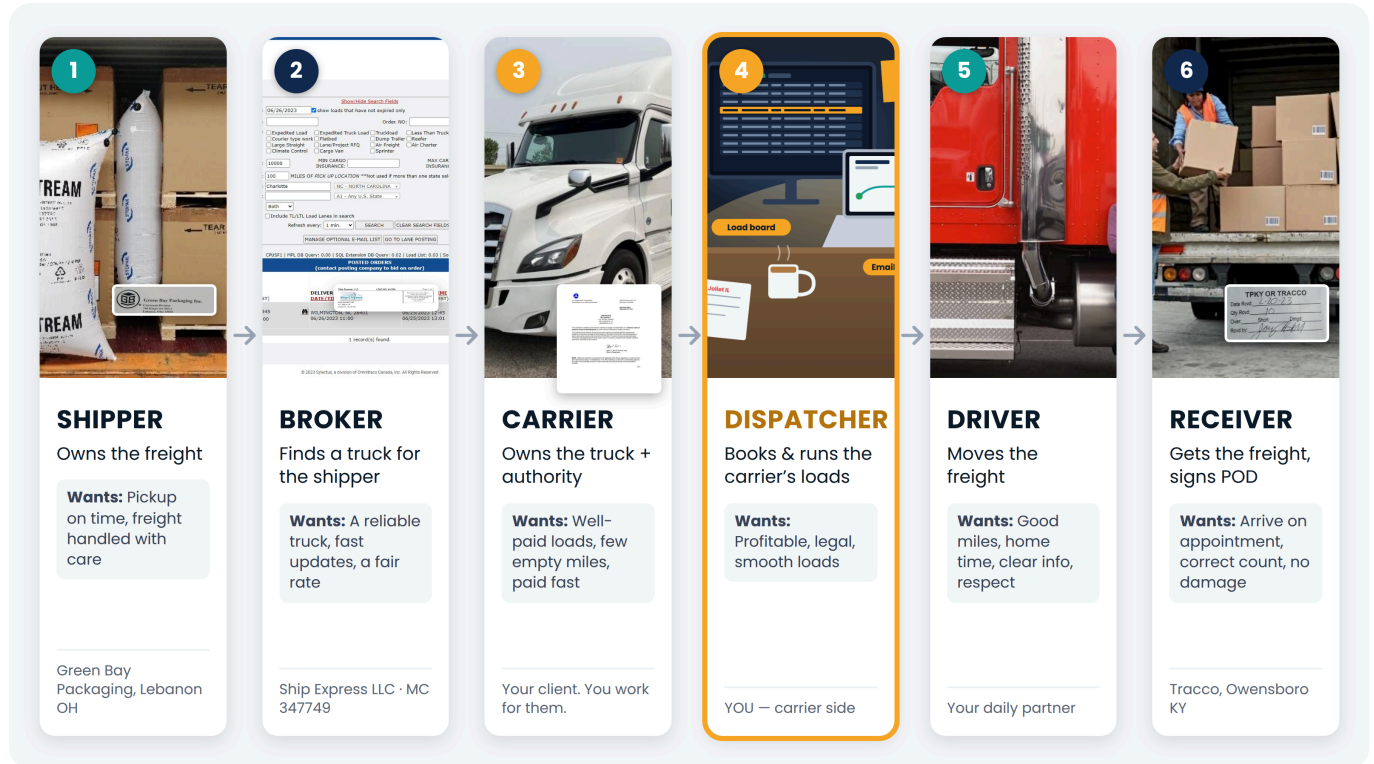
- L1.1** Six players, three flows, one real load
- L1.2** What a dispatcher does, hour by hour
- L1.3** Dispatcher vs broker: the legal line

### After it you can

- Name every party on a load and what they want
- Trace freight, paper and money through one load
- Read a real RC, BOL and POD and spot problems
- Tell dispatcher activity from broker activity

# One load, six players

Every load you ever book has the same cast. The photos and document snippets below come from one real load that we follow through this whole lesson: **load #12354, Lebanon, Ohio → Owensboro, Kentucky.**



## Read the picture left to right

The **shipper** has freight to move. It hires a **broker**, who posts the load and looks for a truck. The broker books a **carrier**, and the carrier's **dispatcher** (you) negotiates and books that load. The carrier's **driver** picks it up and delivers it to the **receiver**, who signs for it.

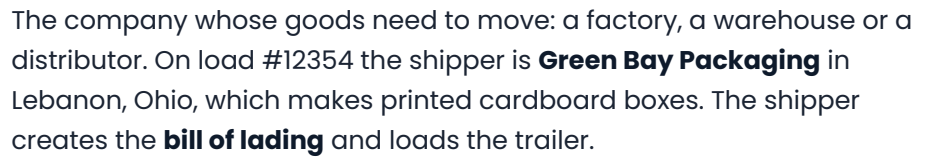
## Where you sit

You sit **inside the carrier's business**, not between the broker and the carrier. That one idea decides who pays you, whose interests you defend on a call, and which activities are legal for you (Lesson 1.3).



### Memorise it as a chain

**Shipper → Broker → Carrier (Dispatcher + Driver) → Receiver.** When someone on the phone confuses you, ask yourself: which link in the chain is this person?



Freight picked up on time, loaded safely, delivered on time and undamaged, at a good price.

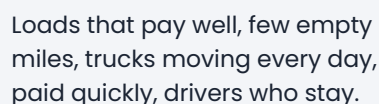
Usually **not directly**. The broker is your contact. Your driver meets shipping staff at the dock. You may call the shipper only for practical questions, if the broker allows it.

A licensed middleman. It has contracts with shippers and finds carriers to move their loads, earning the difference between what the shipper pays and what it pays the carrier. On our load: **Ship Express LLC**, MC 347749. The broker posts loads on load boards and issues the **rate confirmation**.

A reliable truck at the lowest workable rate, fast updates, tracking turned on, no surprises for their shipper.

Your main phone contact. Verify them, ask questions, negotiate, follow their rules, keep them updated. Professional, never desperate.

The company that owns the truck and has **operating authority** to haul for hire (USDOT and, today, an MC number). It can be one owner-operator or a fleet. On our load the carrier is a small company running a **26' straight box truck**.



**Your client or employer.** You follow their preferences: lanes, minimum rates, home time, types of freight they refuse.

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# Driver, receiver — and the supporting cast



The professional behind the wheel, either an employee or the owner-operator himself. The driver inspects the truck, checks the freight count at pickup, signs the BOL, drives within hours-of-service limits and gets the POD signed at delivery.

## What they want

Good paying miles, predictable schedules, home time, clear and complete instructions, and respect.

## How you deal with them

Daily, by phone and WhatsApp. You plan **with** drivers, not **at** them. A driver who trusts you will tell you about problems early.

**Words:** HOS · ELD · check call · ETA · PU / DEL · detention · layover



Also called the **consignee**: the place the freight goes. On our load, **Tracco** in Owensboro, Kentucky. It unloads, counts, notes any damage and signs the BOL, which turns it into the **proof of delivery**.

## What they want

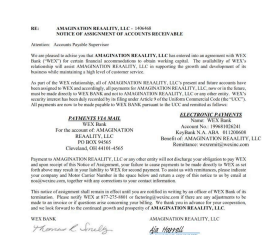
A truck that arrives on its appointment with the correct count and no damage.

## How you deal with them

Mostly through the driver and broker. Appointment changes normally go through the broker.

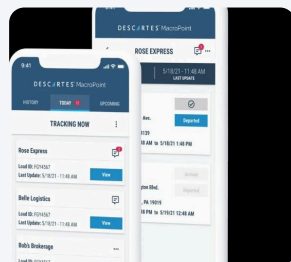
**Words:** consignee · receiving hours · lumper (paid unloader) · OS&D (over, short and damaged)

## The supporting cast



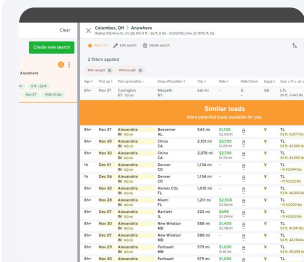
## Factoring company

Pays the carrier quickly for its invoices, then collects from the broker, for a fee. A **Notice of Assignment (NOA)** tells brokers to pay the factor.



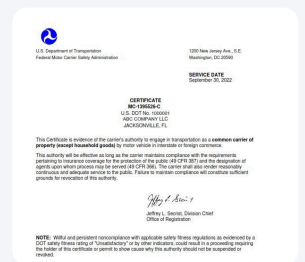
## Tracking app

Apps such as MacroPoint share the truck's location with the broker. Our RC made tracking mandatory, with a \$150 penalty.



## Load board

The marketplace where brokers post loads and carriers search, e.g. DAT and Truckstop. Module 6.

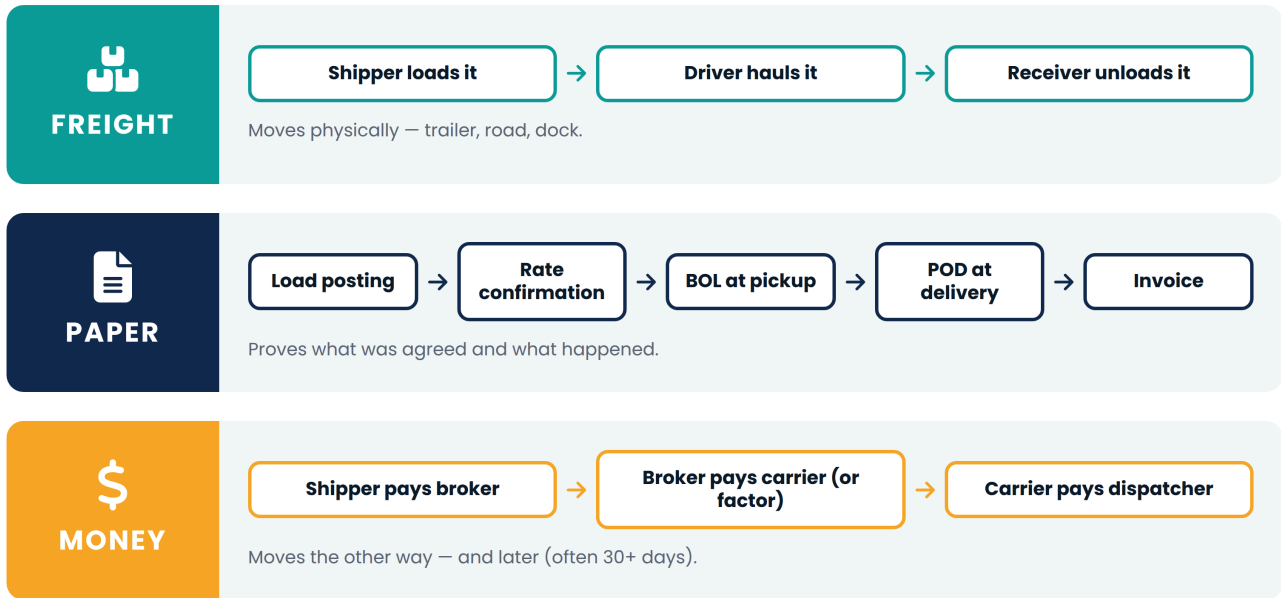


## FMCSA

The U.S. federal regulator. It grants authority and publishes company records used to verify carriers and brokers.

# Freight, paper and money move differently

Beginners picture one line from shipper to receiver. Experienced dispatchers see **three lines at the same time**, and know that problems happen where they don't match.



## Freight

Moves in hours or days. Your job: the right truck, at the right place, at the right time, and a legal driver.

## Paper

Every step leaves a document. If it isn't on paper, it didn't happen: no RC, no agreement; no POD, no payment.

## Money

Moves last and in the **opposite direction**. Brokers often pay 15–45 days after receiving the paperwork, which is why carriers use factoring.

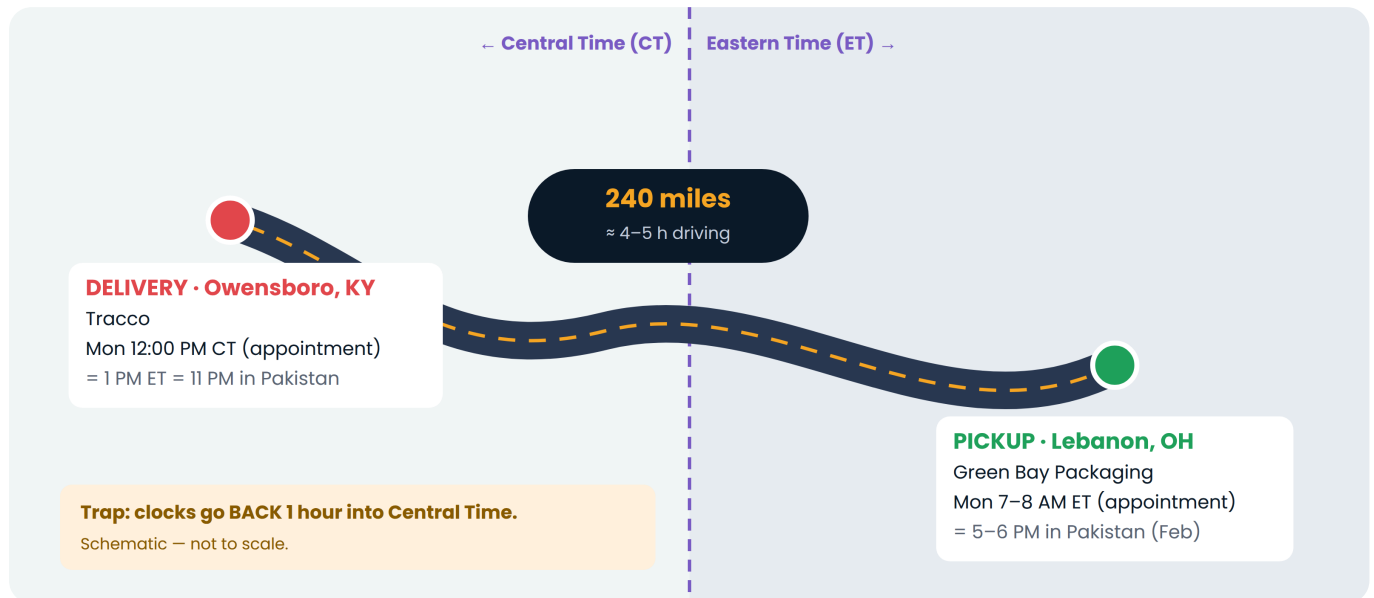


### Your job touches all three

You **arrange** the freight, you **check and collect** the paper, and you **protect** the money by booking with brokers who pay and by sending clean paperwork fast. But the broker's money never passes through your hands (Lesson 1.3).

# Follow one real load: #12354

This is a real load from your OMNITECH training manual, with its real paperwork. Treat it like a file on your desk.



| Load file #12354 |                                                   |
|------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Broker</b>    | Ship Express LLC, Lebanon OH • MC 347749          |
| <b>Shipper</b>   | Green Bay Packaging, 760 Kingsview Dr, Lebanon OH |
| <b>Receiver</b>  | Tracco, Owensboro KY                              |
| <b>Equipment</b> | 26' straight box truck                            |
| <b>Freight</b>   | "Skidded paper": 10 skids of printed boxes        |
| <b>Distance</b>  | 240 miles                                         |
| <b>Rate</b>      | \$700 flat = \$2.92 per loaded mile               |
| <b>Dates</b>     | Booked Sat 18 Feb 2023 • PU & DEL Mon 20 Feb      |

## Why this load is a good teacher

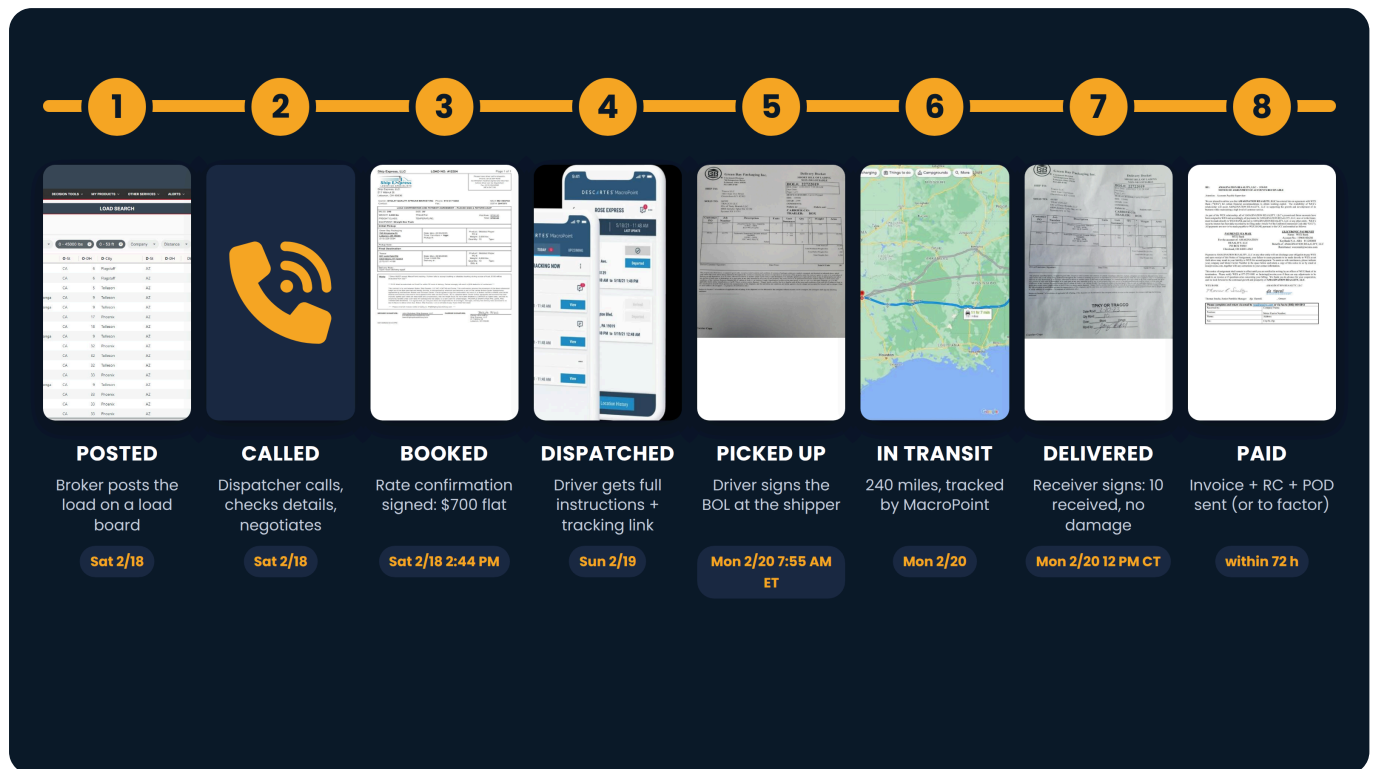
- It is **short and simple**: one pickup, one delivery, same day.
- It **crosses a time zone**: Ohio is Eastern, western Kentucky is Central.
- Its rate confirmation has typical **broker penalty clauses**.
- Its paperwork contains **two real mismatches** for you to catch on page 28.



### Before you turn the page

Pickup is 7–8 AM Eastern and delivery is 12 PM Central, 240 miles away. Is 4–5 hours of driving enough? What time does the driver need to leave the shipper? (Think about loading time and the time-zone change.)

# The life of load #12354 in eight stops



| Stop                | What happened                                              | What the dispatcher did or checked                                                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>1 Posted</b>     | Ship Express posted a box-truck load, Lebanon → Owensboro. | Spotted it while searching near the truck's location. Checked equipment, dates and weight.                                               |
| <b>2 Called</b>     | Dispatcher called the broker.                              | Confirmed the load was available, asked for commodity, weight, appointments and rules, then negotiated. Verified the broker's authority. |
| <b>3 Booked</b>     | RC issued Sat 18 Feb 2:44 PM.                              | Read every line, including the penalties, then had the carrier sign it. <b>No signed RC, no dispatch.</b>                                |
| <b>4 Dispatched</b> | Driver received instructions.                              | Sent addresses, appointment times in the driver's zone, load number, and the MacroPoint tracking requirement.                            |
| <b>5 Picked up</b>  | BOL printed Mon 20 Feb 7:55 AM.                            | Confirmed the driver arrived on time, got the count (10) and a photo of the BOL. Compared it with the RC.                                |
| <b>6 In transit</b> | 240 miles, crossing into Central Time.                     | Watched tracking and updated the broker. Recalculated the ETA in Central Time.                                                           |
| <b>7 Delivered</b>  | Receiver stamped and signed: 10 received, no OS&D.         | Got a clear photo of the signed POD immediately.                                                                                         |
| <b>8 Paid</b>       | Invoice with RC and POD sent to AP@ShipExpress.            | Sent the POD well inside 72 hours to avoid the \$150 deduction, or sent it to the factoring company.                                     |

# The rate confirmation

**1 Ship Express, LLC** **2 LOAD NO: #12354** Page 1 of 1

**3** **Carrier:** SHOLAY QUALITY AFRICAN MARKET INC Phone: 973-517-6383  
Contact: MC # MC1486753  
Fax: DOT # 3947871

**4** **LOAD CONFIRMATION AND PAYMENT AGREEMENT -- PLEASE SIGN & RETURN ASAP**

**5** **Flat Rate:** \$700.00  
**Total:** \$700.00

**6** **Initial Pickup**

|                                                                                       |                                                                                        |                                                                                                               |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Green Bay Packaging</b><br>760 Kingsview Dr<br>Lebanon, OH 45036<br>(513) 228-5594 | <b>Date:</b> Mon, 02/20/2023<br><b>Time:</b> 7am-8am ✓ <b>Appt</b><br><b>Pickup #:</b> | <b>Product:</b> Skidded Paper<br><b>PO #:</b><br><b>Weight:</b> 2,000 lbs<br><b>Quantity:</b> 10 <b>Type:</b> |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

**7** **Final Destination**

|                                                                              |                                                                             |                                                                                                                                |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Tracco</b><br>901 Leitchfield Rd<br>Owensboro, KY 42303<br>(270) 971-4158 | <b>Date:</b> Mon, 02/20/2023<br><b>Time:</b> 12:00 PM<br><b>Delivery #:</b> | <b>Product:</b> Skidded Paper<br><b>PO #:</b><br><b>Weight:</b> 2,000 lbs<br><b>Quantity:</b> 10 <b>Type:</b><br><b>BOL #:</b> |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

**8** **Note** \*\*Driver MUST accept MacroPoint tracking. If driver fails to accept tracking or disables tracking during course of load, \$150 will be deducted from rate\*\*

**9** \*\*\*P.O.D Must be submitted via Email/Fax within 72 hours of delivery. Failure to comply will result in \$150 deduction of settlement.\*\*\*

**10** This contract is by and between Broker, Ship Express, LLC MC # 347749 and Carrier. This confirmation governs the movement of the above-referenced freight as of the date specified and hereby amends, is incorporated by reference and becomes a part of that certain Broker-Carrier Transportation Agreement by and between 'Broker' and 'Contract Carrier'. Carrier agrees to sign the confirmation and return it to Broker via FAX or EMAIL and Carrier shall be conclusively presumed to have agreed to the rates set forth herein. By its signature below Carrier further represents and warrants that said mutually agreed upon rates are reasonable and compensatory, that the freight would not have been tendered to CARRIER at higher rates, and that no shipments handled under such rates will subsequently be subject to a later claim for undercharges. FACSIMILE SIGNATURES ARE LEGAL AND THEREFORE BINDING. It is agreed that you and your driver are responsible for all shortages, damages, and any late delivery fees assessed to us due to failure to deliver when due. Broker, Ship Express, LLC is not liable to pay Truck Order Not Used.

**11** **BROKER SIGNATURE:** John Brubaker, Ship Express, LLC  
john@shipexpressdelivery.com  
www.shipexpressdelivery.com

**CARRIER SIGNATURE:** Joseph Price  
Please send bill to:  
Ship Express, LLC  
211 Walnut St  
Lebanon, OH 45036

02/18/2023 02:44 PM

## Anatomy of a real rate confirmation

The rate confirmation (RC) is the contract between broker and carrier for one load. The dispatcher reviews every line before the carrier signs.

- 1 Broker**  
Ship Express LLC, MC 347749 — who you are contracting with.
- 2 Load number**  
#12354 — quote it on every call, email and invoice.
- 3 Carrier**  
Your carrier's legal name, MC and DOT. Must be exactly right.
- 4 Load facts**  
240 mi - 2,000 lb - 26' straight box truck.
- 5 Rate**  
\$700 flat, all-in. No fuel surcharge line.
- 6 Pickup + appointment**  
Green Bay Packaging, Mon 2/20, 7-8 AM appointment.
- 7 Delivery + appointment**  
Tracco, Owensboro KY, 12 PM (noon) appointment.
- 8 Tracking rule**  
Driver must accept MacroPoint or \$150 is deducted.
- 9 POD deadline**  
POD within 72 h of delivery or \$150 deducted.
- 10 TONU clause**  
"Not liable to pay Truck Order Not Used" — no pay if cancelled.
- 11 Signatures**  
Signed by carrier = binding contract. Read before signing.

## Why it matters

The RC is the **legal agreement for this one load** between the broker and the carrier. Whatever was said on the phone, **the RC is what counts**. If a detention or layover rate isn't written in it, expect a fight later.

This RC is also a good example of **penalty clauses**: \$150 for no tracking, \$150 for a late POD, and no TONU (truck order not used) payment if the load is cancelled. None of them is unusual. All of them must be **explained to the driver**.



### The 30-second RC check

Before any signature: **1** carrier name and MC correct · **2** rate matches what you agreed · **3** pickup and delivery addresses, dates and times (with zones) · **4** equipment and weight · **5** special rules and penalties · **6** accessororial terms (detention, layover, TONU).



### Seen on this RC

The weight says **2,000 lb** and the delivery address is **901 Leitchfield Rd**. Keep both in mind for the next two pages.

# The bill of lading (BOL)

**Green Bay Packaging Inc.**  
Cincinnati Division  
760 Kingsview Drive  
Lebanon, Ohio 45036  
513-489-8700

**SHIP TO:**  
Tracco LLC  
1661 East 11th Street  
Owensboro KY 42303

**SOLD TO:**  
66589  
TRACCO LLC  
Div of Tasty Brands LLC  
6800 Jericho Tpke Ste 101W  
Syosset NY 11791

**Delivery Docket**  
**SHORT BILL OF LADING**  
**NON-NEGOTIABLE**

**BOL#:** 22722019  
BOL Date: 2/20/2023 7:55:28 AM  
Page 1 of 1  
DESPATCHMODE: Carrier Prepaid  
EDI: 129446  
LOAD: 2599  
COMMENTS:  
Pallets in: \_\_\_\_\_ Pallets out: \_\_\_\_\_  
**CARRIER CO:**  
**TRAILER:** BOX

| Customer PO | Job Number | Description                                                                     | Units | Unit Summary   | Qty   | P / C | Weight                      | Area   |
|-------------|------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|----------------|-------|-------|-----------------------------|--------|
| P4762       | 301771     | Cured Honey Ham-18436R6<br>D RSC - WPA<br>ECT 44 C FLUTE                        | 2     | 1 150<br>1 375 | 523   | C     | 759                         | 5,160  |
|             |            | Pallets                                                                         |       |                | 2     |       |                             |        |
| P4762       | 301772     | Rotisserie Seasoned Chicken Breast-<br>18436R6<br>D RSC - WPA<br>ECT 44 C FLUTE | 8     | 7 375<br>1 448 | 3,073 | C     | 4,440                       | 30,204 |
|             |            | Pallets                                                                         |       |                | 8     |       |                             |        |
|             |            |                                                                                 |       |                |       |       | Total Area (sf)             | 35,364 |
|             |            |                                                                                 |       |                |       |       | Total Produced Weight (lbs) | 5,199  |
|             |            |                                                                                 |       |                |       |       | Total Pallet Weight (lbs)   | 530    |
|             |            |                                                                                 |       |                |       |       | Total Weight (lbs)          | 5,729  |

**7** Driver/Carrier Signature: \_\_\_\_\_ Date/Time: \_\_\_\_\_ **5** Total # Units **10**

**8** The property described above, in apparent good order, except as noted (contents and condition of contents of packages unknown), marked, consigned, and destined as indicated above, which said carrier (the word carrier being understood throughout this contract as meaning any person or corporation in possession of the property under the contract) agrees to carry to its usual place of delivery at said destination, if on its route, otherwise to deliver to another carrier on the route to said destination. It is mutually agreed, as to each carrier of all or any of said property over all or portion of said route to destination, as to each party at any time interested in all or any of said property, that every service to be performed hereunder shall be subject to all the terms and conditions of the Uniform Domestic Straight Bill of Lading set forth (1) in Uniform Freight Classification in effect on the date hereof, if this is a rail, or a rail-water shipment, or (2) in the applicable motor carrier classification or tariff if this is a motor carrier shipment. Shipper hereby certifies that he is familiar with all the terms and conditions of the said bill of lading set forth in the classification or tariff which governs the transportation of this shipment, and the said terms and conditions are hereby agreed to by the shipper and accepted for himself and his assigns. (Mail or street address of consignee—for purposes of notification only.)

Subject to Section 7 of conditions of applicable bill of lading, if the shipment is to be delivered to the consignee without recourse on the consignor, the consignor shall sign the following statement:

Carrier Copy

## Anatomy of the bill of lading (BOL)

The shipper creates the BOL. It is the receipt for the freight and the carriage contract. The driver signs it at pickup.

- 1 Shipper**  
Green Bay Packaging, Lebanon OH — issues the BOL.
- 2 BOL number**  
22722019 — the shipper's reference for this shipment.
- 3 Ship to**  
Tracco LLC, 1661 East 11th St, Owensboro KY.
- 4 What is inside**  
Printed boxes for ham & chicken products — the "skidded paper".
- 5 Count**  
10 units (pallets/skids). Driver checks the count.
- 6 Weight**  
Total weight 5,729 lb (incl. 530 lb of pallets).
- 7 Driver signature**  
Driver signs at pickup = received in good order.
- 8 Contract terms**  
Standard straight-BOL terms of carriage.

## Why it matters

The BOL is created by the **shipper**. It says what was loaded, how many pieces and how much weight, and where it goes. When the driver signs it at pickup, the carrier accepts the freight "in apparent good order." The BOL is also a **contract of carriage**: the fine print explains the terms.

Notice the description: the "skidded paper" on the RC is really **printed corrugated boxes** for ham and chicken products ("ECT 44 C flute" describes the board strength). The freight is packaging, not food.



### What the driver checks before signing

**Count** (does 10 match what was loaded?) · **condition** (damage noted?) · **seal number** if sealed · **shipper's name and receiver address**. Ask the driver to **photograph the signed BOL** and send it to you before leaving the dock.



### Seen on this BOL

Total weight: **5,729 lb**. Ship to: **1661 East 11th Street**. Compare with the RC.

# The proof of delivery (POD)

**Green Bay Packaging Inc.**  
Cincinnati Division  
760 Kingsview Drive  
Lebanon, Ohio 45036  
513-489-8700

**SHIP TO:**  
Tracco LLC  
1661 East 11st Street  
Owensboro KY 42303

**SOLD TO:**  
66589  
TRACCO LLC  
Div of Tasty Brands LLC  
6800 Jericho Tpke Ste 101W  
Syosset NY 11791

**Delivery Docket**  
**SHORT BILL OF LADING**  
**NON-NEGOTIABLE**

**BOL#:** 22722019  
BOL Date: 2/20/2023 7:55:28 AM  
Due Date:  
Page 1 of 1  
DESPATCHMODE: Carrier Prepaid  
EDI: 129446  
LOAD: 2599  
COMMENTS:  
Pallets in: Pallets out:  
**CARRIER CO:**  
**TRAILER:** BOX

| Customer PO | Job Number | Description                                                                                | Units | Unit Summary   | Qty   | P / C | Weight                      | Area   |
|-------------|------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|----------------|-------|-------|-----------------------------|--------|
| P4762       | 301771     | Uncured Honey Ham-18436R6<br>D RSC - WPA<br>ECT 44 C FLUTE<br>Pallets                      | 2     | 1 150<br>1 375 | 525   | C     | 759                         | 5,160  |
| P4762       | 301772     | Rotisserie Seasoned Chicken Breast-<br>18436R6<br>D RSC - WPA<br>ECT 44 C FLUTE<br>Pallets | 8     | 7 375<br>1 448 | 3,073 | C     | 4,440                       | 30,204 |
|             |            |                                                                                            |       |                |       |       | Total Area (sq)             | 35,364 |
|             |            |                                                                                            |       |                |       |       | Total Produced Weight (lbs) | 5,199  |
|             |            |                                                                                            |       |                |       |       | Total Pallet Weight (lbs)   | 530    |
|             |            |                                                                                            |       |                |       |       | Total Weight (lbs)          | 5,729  |

Driver/Customer Signature: Date/Time: Total # Units 10

The property described above, in apparent good order, except as noted (contents and condition of contents of packages unknown), marked, consigned, and destined as indicated above, which said carrier (the word carrier being understood throughout this contract as meaning any person or corporation in possession of the property under the contract) agrees to carry to its usual place of delivery at said destination, if on its route, otherwise to deliver to another carrier on the route to said destination. It is mutually agreed, as to each carrier of all or any of said property over all or any portion of said route to destination, as to each party at any time interested in all or any of said property, that every service to be performed hereunder shall be subject to all the terms and conditions of the Uniform Domestic Straight Bill of Lading set forth (1) in Uniform Freight Classification in effect on the date hereof, if this is a rail, or a rail-water shipment, or (2) in the applicable motor carrier classification or tariff if this is a motor carrier shipment. Shipper hereby certifies that he is familiar with all the terms and conditions of the said bill of lading set forth in the classification or tariff which governs the transportation of this shipment, and the said terms and conditions are hereby agreed to by the shipper and accepted for himself and his assigns. (Mail or street address of consignee - or purposes of notification only.)

Subject to Section 7 of conditions of applicable bill of lading, if the shipment is to be delivered to the consignee without recourse on the consignor, the consignor shall sign the following statement:

1 TPKY OR TRACCO  
2 Date Rcvd: 2-20-23  
3 Qty Rcvd: 10  
4 Over: Short: Dmgd:  
5 Rcvd by: [Signature]

Carrier Copy

## The same paper, signed at delivery = POD

Proof of delivery (POD) is the BOL signed by the receiver. No POD → no payment. On this load the broker wants it within 72 hours.

- 1 **Receiver stamp**  
TPKY or Tracco — the consignee.
- 2 **Date received**  
2-20-23 — same day as pickup.
- 3 **Quantity received**  
10 — matches the BOL count.
- 4 **Over / Short / Damaged**  
All blank = clean delivery. Anything written here = a claim risk.
- 5 **Received by**  
Signature of the receiver. Now the BOL has become the POD.

## Why it matters

The POD is simply the **same BOL, signed by the receiver**, often with a stamp, date, piece count and a space for exceptions. It proves the carrier finished the job. **Brokers pay against the POD**, so it is the most valuable paper in trucking.

On this load the receiver wrote **Qty Rcvd 10** and left Over / Short / Damaged blank. That is a clean delivery, and the carrier can invoice.



### POD habits

Get a **clear, flat, readable photo** of every page right after delivery, before the driver leaves the dock. Check that it is signed, dated and shows the count. Send it the same day with the invoice.



### If anything is written in OS&D

Call the broker **immediately**, tell the carrier, and get photos of the freight. A note like "2 pallets damaged" can become a claim deducted from the rate.

# Who pays whom on load #12354

## Where the money goes on load #12354

Real rate from the rate confirmation; the split below is an illustration.

What the shipper paid the broker — unknown to the carrier



What happens to the carrier's \$700 (illustrative)



### 240 miles • \$700

= **\$2.92 per loaded mile**. Whether that is good depends on the truck's costs and the empty miles to get there — Module 7.

### Dispatch fee

Independent dispatchers are paid by the **carrier**, often a % of each load (practitioner sources commonly quote 5–10%). Employees get salary ± commission.

### Factoring (red, ~3%)

A factoring company pays the carrier in a day or two, then collects from the broker — for a fee. The NOA tells the broker to pay the factor.

Percentages are examples for learning, not market rates.

## The payment chain

- The **shipper pays the broker** an amount the carrier never sees.
- The **broker pays the carrier** the RC rate, here \$700, after receiving the invoice, RC and POD. That is often weeks later.
- If the carrier **factors**, the factoring company pays in a day or two and collects from the broker later.
- The **carrier pays the dispatcher**: a salary from the dispatch company, or a fee for an independent dispatcher.



### A legal red line

A carrier-side dispatcher is **paid by the carrier only**, and broker-to-carrier money should never pass through the dispatcher. If a broker or factor pays you, FMCSA treats that as broker activity.



### Quick math you will use every day

**Rate per mile = rate ÷ miles.**  $\$700 \div 240 = \$2.92/\text{mile}$ . If the truck drove 60 empty miles to reach Lebanon, the rate over all miles is  $\$700 \div 300 =$  **\$2.33/mile**. Empty miles quietly eat the rate (Module 7).

# Catch the mismatch

## Spot the difference: rate confirmation vs bill of lading

Same load, two documents. A good dispatcher compares them before the truck leaves the shipper.

Rate confirmation

(broker)

Lebanon, OH 45036  
(513) 228-5594

Pickup Note:

Final Destination

Tracco  
901 Leitchfield Rd  
Owensboro, KY 42303  
(270) 971-4158

Delivery Note:  
12pm noon delivery appt!

Time: 7am-8am ✓ Appt  
Pickup #:

Date: Mon, 02/20/2023  
Time: 12:00 PM  
Delivery #:

PO #:  
Weight: 2,000  
Quantity: 10

Product: Skids  
PO #:  
Weight: 2,000  
Quantity: 10  
BOL #:

513-489-8700

SHIP TO:

Tracco LLC  
1661 East 11st Street  
Owensboro KY 42303

SOLD TO:

66589  
TRACCO LLC  
Div of Tasty Brands LLC  
6800 Jericho Tpke Ste 101W  
Syosset NY 11791

BOL #: 2272

BOL Date: 2/20/2023  
Due Date:  
Page 1 of 1  
DESPATCHMODE: C  
EDI: 129446  
LOAD: 2599  
COMMENTS:  
Pallets in: \_\_\_\_\_  
CARRIER CO: \_\_\_\_\_  
TRAILER: B

| Customer PO | Job Number | Description                   | Units | Unit Summary | Qty | P / C |
|-------------|------------|-------------------------------|-------|--------------|-----|-------|
| 84762       | 30177      | Unbranded Skids 14mm 14x10x10 | 1     | 1            | 1   | 1     |

FIELD

RATE CONFIRMATION

Count

Quantity 10

Weight

2,000 lb

Delivery address

901 Leitchfield Rd

BILL OF LADING

10 units ✓

5,729 lb ✗

1661 East 11th St ✗

### Your task

- Which two fields don't match between the RC and the BOL?
- Why could the weight difference matter for a **box truck** in particular?
- Which address should the driver use, and how do you find out for sure?
- Who do you contact, and when: before booking, at pickup, or after delivery?
- What do you ask for in writing?



#### Dispatcher habit: compare RC and BOL at pickup

As soon as the driver sends a photo of the BOL, compare **count, weight, commodity and delivery address** with the RC. Differences are much cheaper to fix at the shipper than at the receiver's gate.



#### Why real paperwork differs

Brokers often post an estimated weight, and a shipper can have several buildings in one city. Usually the fix is a two-minute phone call. Sometimes it changes the rate, the legality or the equipment. You only know if you check.

Suggested answers are in the answer key at the back.

# The eight steps, in detail

The loop from Lesson 0.1, now as a working checklist. Each step has a tool, an output you can check, and a classic beginner mistake.

| Step               | What you do                                                                                                                                  | Main tool                             | Output                            | Classic mistake                                                  |
|--------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>1 Find</b>      | Search load boards around where and when the truck will be empty. Shortlist loads that fit the equipment, the dates and the carrier's lanes. | Load board                            | Shortlist of 3–6 loads            | Searching only the exact city, or ignoring deadhead              |
| <b>2 Vet</b>       | Check the broker's authority and status, credit / days-to-pay, contact details and fraud signals before you invest time.                     | FMCSA records, load-board credit data | Go / no-go on the broker          | Trusting an email address or phone number from the posting alone |
| <b>3 Call</b>      | Confirm the load is available. Ask about commodity, weight, pickup and delivery times, and any special rules.                                | Phone, notes                          | Complete load facts               | Talking about the rate before knowing the details                |
| <b>4 Negotiate</b> | Know the carrier's floor. Ask for more with reasons: market, deadhead, tight timing. Walk away if it's below the floor.                      | Rate tools, floor rate                | Agreed rate                       | Accepting the first offer, or bluffing without data              |
| <b>5 Book</b>      | Receive the RC, check every line, get the carrier to sign, return it. Complete broker setup if it's a new broker.                            | Email, e-sign, carrier packet         | Signed RC                         | Signing with a wrong time, weight or clause                      |
| <b>6 Dispatch</b>  | Send the driver one complete message: addresses, times with zones, PU#, load #, rules, tracking, contacts.                                   | WhatsApp / TMS                        | Driver confirms receipt           | Sending instructions in 8 separate texts                         |
| <b>7 Track</b>     | Check calls at pickup, loaded, mid-route and delivery. Update the broker before they ask. Solve problems early.                              | ELD / tracking app, phone             | On-time delivery, broker informed | Going silent when there's bad news                               |
| <b>8 Close</b>     | Get a clean POD, send the invoice package, log the load, plan the next one.                                                                  | Email, factoring portal, load log     | Paid load, next load planned      | Waiting a day to send the POD                                    |



## Outputs, not activity

At the end of a shift, count outputs: **loads booked, RCs signed, PODs sent, trucks planned for tomorrow.** Hours on the phone are not a result.



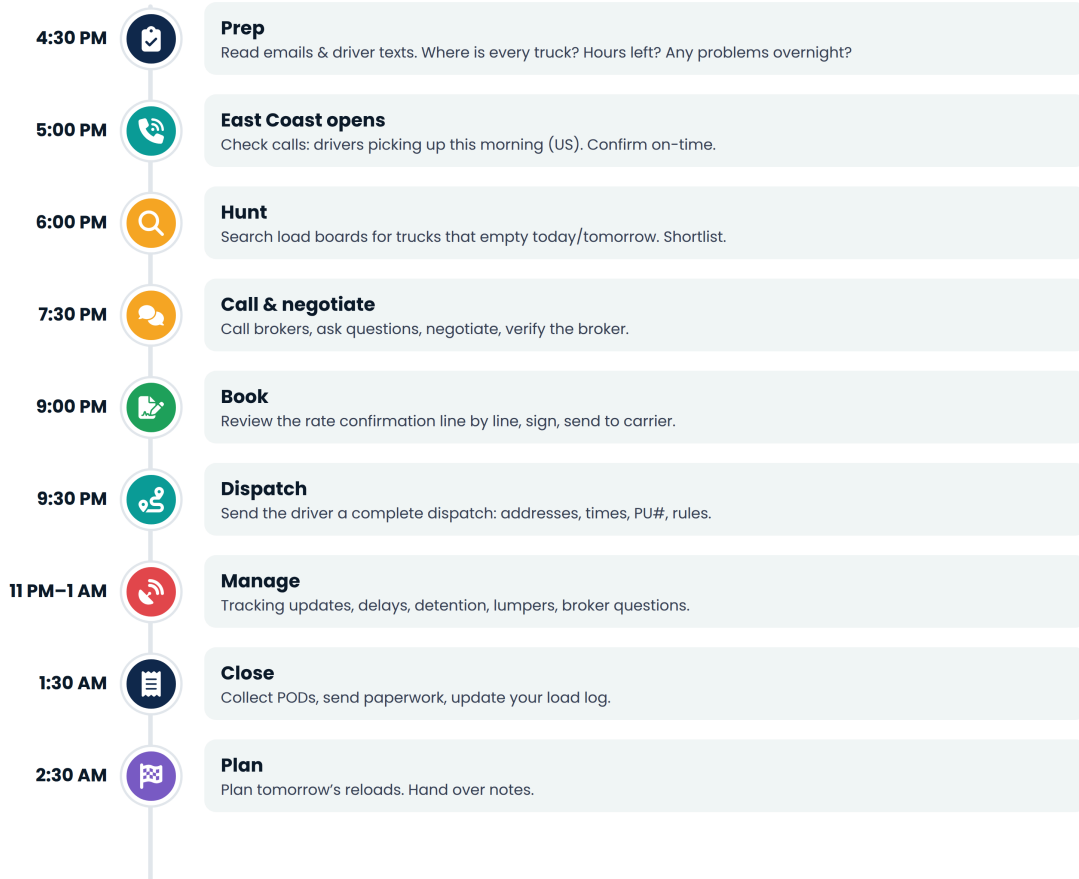
## Where each step is taught

Find → Module 6 · Vet → Module 8 · Call & negotiate → Module 8 · Book & dispatch → Module 9 · Track & close → Modules 9–10. The feasibility checks behind every step come from Modules 2–4 and 7.

# A night on the desk

## A typical night shift — Pakistan time

Example during U.S. daylight saving time. Real shifts vary by employer and fleet.



## Two rhythms at once

Today's loads are moving right now, and tomorrow's loads must be found and booked before other trucks take them. Early in the shift you watch pickups, in the middle you hunt and book, late in the shift you close and plan.



### Plan loads a day ahead

The best dispatchers book the next load **before** the current one delivers, so the driver rolls straight from delivery to the next pickup.

## How many trucks?

Beginners often run 2–4 trucks. Experienced dispatchers may handle 8–15, depending on the freight type and support. More trucks is not better if the quality drops.

# The driver relationship and who you talk to



## Why drivers make or break you

The driver is the one person who sees the freight, the dock and the road. A driver who trusts you tells you early: “the shipper is slow,” “my hours are tight,” “the trailer has a problem.” A driver who doesn’t will switch off tracking, go quiet, or quit.

## What drivers remember

- Did the dispatcher **tell the truth** about the load?
- Was the information **complete** the first time?
- Did they **respect home time** and hours?
- Did they **answer the phone** when things went wrong?

## Who you contact, about what

| Contact                   | Typical topics                                                                         | Channel                       |
|---------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| <b>Carrier owner</b>      | Lanes, floor rates, which trucks are available, home time, approvals for unusual loads | Call, WhatsApp                |
| <b>Driver</b>             | Location, hours left, dispatch instructions, check calls, BOL and POD photos, problems | WhatsApp, call                |
| <b>Broker</b>             | Load details, rate, RC, setup packet, updates, detention, delays, paperwork            | Call + email (written record) |
| <b>Shipper / receiver</b> | Rare, practical only: gate instructions, dock hours, if the broker allows it           | Call                          |
| <b>Factoring company</b>  | Submitting invoices and PODs, payment status                                           | Portal, email                 |



### Bad news travels fast — and first from you

If a truck will be late, the broker should hear it **from you, early, with a new ETA and a reason**, never from the receiver. Brokers forgive delays. They don’t forgive surprises.



### Say it out loud — a check call

**“Hi Carlos, it’s Jawad. Quick check: are you loaded at Green Bay Packaging? What’s your piece count and BOL number? Can you send me a photo of the BOL before you leave? Thanks — drive safe.”**

# The legal line

This is the most important boundary in your career. Stay on the carrier side of it and you are doing a legitimate job. Cross it without broker registration and you are brokering illegally, even if your title says “dispatcher.”

## Broker — federal definition (summary)

A person who, **for compensation, arranges or offers to arrange** transportation of property by an authorized motor carrier. A carrier’s own employees and **bona fide agents** are not brokers when they arrange loads for that carrier. (49 CFR 371.2(a))

## Bona fide agent — federal definition

People “who are part of the normal organization of a motor carrier and perform duties under the carrier’s directions pursuant to a **preexisting agreement which provides for a continuing relationship**, precluding the exercise of discretion on the part of the agent in **allocating traffic** between the carrier and others.” (49 CFR 371.2(b))

## What FMCSA’s 2023 guidance says about dispatch services

### ✓ Generally NOT a broker when the dispatch service...

- has a **written contract** with the motor carrier appointing it as agent
- **does not seek or solicit shippers** for freight
- is **paid only by the motor carrier**
- is **not an intermediary** in the broker–carrier payment
- does **not re-assign** the load to another carrier

### ✗ Needs broker registration when it...

- negotiates freight **directly with a shipper**
- takes **compensation from a broker or factoring company** for a load
- **accepts a shipment without a truck**, then looks for one
- **allocates traffic**: accepts a load that could go to more than one carrier and chooses who gets it



### What is at stake

Unauthorized brokerage can bring civil penalties of up to **\$10,000 per violation**, plus liability to injured parties for all valid claims. Officers and principals can be personally liable (49 U.S.C. 14916). Brokers must register with FMCSA and file **\$75,000** of financial security (49 CFR 387.307).

This course teaches compliance awareness, not legal advice. For your own business structure later, speak to a U.S. transportation attorney.

# Six questions before you act

## The broker line: six questions before you act

Based on FMCSA final guidance on brokers and bona fide agents (June 2023). Awareness, not legal advice.

1 Do I have a **written agreement** with this carrier to act as its agent?

✓ YES

NO →

✗ Stop. Get the dispatch agreement signed first.

2 Does my pay come **only from the carrier**?

✓ YES

NO →

✗ Pay from a broker or factor = broker activity.

3 Am I dealing with brokers — **not finding freight directly from shippers**?

✓ YES

NO →

✗ Negotiating directly with a shipper = broker activity.

4 Did I have a **specific truck** before accepting the load?

✓ YES

NO →

✗ Accepting freight, then finding a truck = brokering.

5 Is this load for **one carrier I represent** — not me choosing between carriers?

✓ YES

NO →

✗ Allocating a load among carriers = brokering.

6 Does broker → carrier money go **directly**, not through me?

✓ YES

NO →

✗ Being in the payment chain = broker activity.



All YES → you are working as the carrier's agent (carrier-side dispatcher), not as a broker.



### Use it when something feels unusual

Normal carrier-side work passes all six questions without thinking. Use the tree when a request is **new or strange**: a shipper calls you directly, a broker offers to pay you a bonus, a friend's carrier "needs a truck for this load you already accepted."

# Boundary cases: green or red?

For each case decide: **GREEN** normal carrier-side dispatching, **RED** broker activity or serious risk, or **AMBER** legal but needs fixing. Then name the tree question that decides it.

**A** Your dispatch company has signed agreements with three carriers. A broker offers a load. You call the carrier whose truck is empty nearby, get approval, and book it in that carrier's name.

Green / red? Which question in the tree decides it?

**B** A factory manager in Texas finds you on LinkedIn and asks you to move 10 loads a week. You agree on a price with him and plan to find trucks later.

Green / red? Which question in the tree decides it?

**C** A broker says: "Book this load with your carrier at \$1,900 and I'll send you \$100 personally."

Green / red? Which question in the tree decides it?

**D** You have agreements with two carriers whose trucks are both near Dallas. You accept a Dallas load from a broker, then decide which of the two carriers gets it and at what split.

Green / red? Which question in the tree decides it?

**E** Your carrier pays you 7% of each load's gross. The broker pays the carrier directly, or pays the carrier's factoring company.

Green / red? Which question in the tree decides it?

**F** To "make it easier," the broker sends payment to your bank account and you forward it to the carrier after taking your fee.

Green / red? Which question in the tree decides it?

**G** Your carrier's truck breaks down after booking. The broker cancels, and you move on to the next load for the same carrier.

Green / red? Which question in the tree decides it?

**H** You work without any written agreement for an owner-operator you met in a Facebook group. He pays you by money transfer.

Green / red? Which question in the tree decides it?

## Scoring

Answers are in the key. You should get at least **7 of 8**. Any case you miss, re-read the FMCSA lists on page 32.

# Module 1 check

1. Put these in order: carrier, receiver, broker, shipper. Where does the dispatcher sit?
2. Who creates the BOL, and who creates the RC?
3. What turns a BOL into a POD?
4. Load #12354 paid \$700 for 240 miles. What is the rate per loaded mile? And the rate per total mile if the truck drove 80 empty miles first?
5. Name the three penalties or risks written in the Ship Express RC.
6. Why does the money flow “in the opposite direction and later”? What problem does factoring solve?
7. Delivery is 12 PM Central in Owensboro. What time is that in Eastern Time? And in Pakistan in February?
8. Give two reasons to get a photo of the BOL before the driver leaves the shipper.
9. What must you do immediately if a receiver writes “1 pallet damaged” on the POD?
10. Name four activities that turn a “dispatcher” into an unregistered broker.
11. Who should pay a carrier-side dispatcher?
12. Explain the difference between a driver’s check call and a broker update.



## Say it out loud — drill 2: the phonetic alphabet

On calls you will spell MC numbers, emails and load numbers. Learn this table and practise spelling your name, your email, and **“Ship Express, load 12354.”**

|                  |                   |                         |                |
|------------------|-------------------|-------------------------|----------------|
| <b>A</b> Alpha   | <b>B</b> Bravo    | <b>C</b> Charlie        | <b>D</b> Delta |
| <b>E</b> Echo    | <b>F</b> Foxtrot  | <b>G</b> Golf           | <b>H</b> Hotel |
| <b>I</b> India   | <b>J</b> Juliett  | <b>K</b> Kilo           | <b>L</b> Lima  |
| <b>M</b> Mike    | <b>N</b> November | <b>O</b> Oscar          | <b>P</b> Papa  |
| <b>Q</b> Quebec  | <b>R</b> Romeo    | <b>S</b> Sierra         | <b>T</b> Tango |
| <b>U</b> Uniform | <b>V</b> Victor   | <b>W</b> Whiskey        | <b>X</b> X-ray |
| <b>Y</b> Yankee  | <b>Z</b> Zulu     | Numbers: say each digit |                |

Numbers: read MC and phone numbers digit by digit, in groups. “MC 1-4-8-6-7-5-3” and “five-one-three, nine-three-four, four-zero-seven-eight.” Say “zero,” not “oh,” for clarity.



## Drill 3: the load read-back

After a broker gives you details, read them back: **“So that’s pickup Monday, 7 to 8 AM Eastern, Green Bay Packaging in Lebanon, Ohio; delivery Monday noon Central, Tracco in Owensboro, Kentucky; 10 skids, 2,000 pounds, box truck. Correct?”**

# Answers — Module 0

- 0.1** For a **motor carrier**. Main goal: keep the carrier's trucks loaded with profitable, legal freight, and get the loads delivered and paid.
- 0.2** Any three of: truck/trailer, operating authority (USDOT/MC), insurance, a load-board subscription or seat, the ELD/tracking system.
- 0.3** "No, thanks." Shared logins break platform rules, can be seen as fraud, and every search would be under someone else's identity. Access should come from a carrier or employer, as your own seat.
- 0.4** October = daylight saving time. Atlanta is Eastern: PKT = ET + 9. 2 PM ET = **11 PM PKT**.
- 0.5** January = standard time. Los Angeles is Pacific: PKT = PT + 13. 7 AM PT = **8 PM PKT**, same day.
- 0.6** Owners with 10 or fewer trucks often drive themselves or have no office staff. They can't search, call and do paperwork while driving, and empty days cost them money.
- 0.7** **False**. There is no federal dispatcher license. But if your activities are brokerage, you need broker registration.
- 0.8** No. A dead market can mean a long empty drive or a cheap load to get out again. Always consider the next load and the empty miles (Module 7).
- 0.9** 6–12 months' experience. Plan: build portfolio evidence (mock calls, RC review, simulation log), target entry roles, and apply after Module 8.
- 0.10** "PU Thu 9:00 AM CT (Thu 7:00 PM PKT)" — summer: PKT = CT + 10.
- Try it** 6 AM Central on Tuesday in late September (summer): PKT = CT + 10, so **Tuesday 4 PM PKT**.
- p.22** Pickup 7–8 AM ET. If loading takes about 1 hour, the driver leaves around 8:30–9 AM ET. 240 miles is about 4–5 h, so arrival is around 1–2 PM ET. Delivery is 12 PM **Central** = 1 PM ET. That is **tight**: the clock goes back one hour, which helps, but slow loading or traffic could make the truck late. A dispatcher flags this before booking.

## Answers — mismatch exercise (page 28)

- 1** **Weight** (RC 2,000 lb vs BOL 5,729 lb) and **delivery address** (RC 901 Leitchfield Rd vs BOL 1661 East 11th St). The count, 10, matches.
- 2** Box trucks have much smaller payload capacity than 53' trailers. A weight almost three times higher could exceed what that specific truck can legally carry, and it may justify a different rate.
- 3** Don't guess. Call the broker (and, if needed, the receiver) to confirm the correct delivery location before the driver leaves the shipper.
- 4** The **broker**, as soon as the BOL photo arrives at pickup, before the truck leaves. Ideally, confirm the weight on the booking call.
- 5** A **revised rate confirmation** showing the correct weight and address. Any agreed change in rate must also be in writing.

# Answers — Module 1 and boundary cases

- 1.1** Shipper → broker → carrier → receiver. The dispatcher sits **inside the carrier**.
- 1.2** The **shipper** creates the BOL. The **broker** creates the RC.
- 1.3** The receiver's signature (usually with date, count and stamp) at delivery.
- 1.4**  $\$700 \div 240 = \$2.92$  per loaded mile.  $\$700 \div 320 = \$2.19$  per total mile.
- 1.5** MacroPoint tracking required (\$150 deduction), POD within 72 h (\$150 deduction), no TONU pay if the load is cancelled.
- 1.6** The broker pays after the job is done and the paperwork arrives, often weeks later. Factoring gives the carrier cash in a day or two, for a fee.
- 1.7** 12 PM CT = **1 PM ET**. In February (standard time) PKT = CT + 11, so **11 PM PKT**.
- 1.8** To compare it with the RC (count, weight, address) while problems can still be fixed at the shipper, and to have proof of what was loaded in case of a later dispute.
- 1.9** Call the broker immediately, inform the carrier, and get photos of the freight and the signed POD. Document everything for a possible claim.
- 1.10** Any four: negotiating directly with shippers; taking pay from a broker or factor; accepting a load before having a truck; allocating a load between carriers; handling broker-to-carrier payments.
- 1.11** The **carrier only**, or your employer, which is paid by its carriers.
- 1.12** A check call is you getting status **from the driver** (location, loaded, count, ETA). A broker update is you **telling the broker** that status, proactively.

| Case | Verdict | Why                                                                                            |
|------|---------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A    | GREEN   | Written agreements; the load is booked for one specific carrier with a truck. Normal dispatch. |
| B    | RED     | Negotiating directly with a shipper and accepting freight without a truck (Q3, Q4).            |
| C    | RED     | Pay from a broker (Q2). It is also a conflict of interest against your carrier.                |
| D    | RED     | Accepting a load and then choosing between carriers is allocating traffic (Q4, Q5).            |
| E    | GREEN   | Paid by the carrier, and broker money goes to the carrier or its factor directly.              |
| F    | RED     | You are in the payment chain (Q6), and it is a major fraud risk.                               |
| G    | GREEN   | A normal operational problem, not a legal one. Handle it professionally (Module 10).           |
| H    | AMBER   | No written agreement (Q1). Get a signed dispatch agreement before working.                     |

# Glossary

**Accessorial** — Extra charge on top of the line-haul rate: detention, layover, lumper, TONU.

**Appointment** — A fixed pickup or delivery time slot. The opposite is FCFS.

**Bill of lading (BOL)** — Shipper's document listing the freight; receipt and carriage contract, signed at pickup.

**Bona fide agent** — Someone who works within a carrier's organization under a continuing agreement. A carrier-side dispatcher aims to be this.

**Broker** — Licensed middleman who arranges transport between shippers and carriers for compensation.

**Carrier** — Company with authority that owns or operates trucks and hauls freight for hire.

**Check call** — A status call or text with the driver: location, loaded, ETA.

**COI** — Certificate of insurance: proof the carrier's insurance is active.

**Consignee** — The receiver of the freight.

**Deadhead** — Empty miles driven without paid freight, e.g. to reach a pickup.

**Detention** — Payment for waiting too long at a shipper or receiver, if the RC allows it.

**ELD** — Electronic logging device: records the driver's hours of service.

**ETA** — Estimated time of arrival. Always give it with a time zone.

**Factoring** — Selling invoices to a factoring company for fast cash, minus a fee.

**FCFS** — First come, first served: no appointment, but open hours.

**FMCSA** — Federal Motor Carrier Safety Administration, the U.S. trucking regulator.

**HOS** — Hours of service: federal limits on driving and duty time.

**Lane** — An origin–destination route, e.g. Chicago → Atlanta.

**Load board** — Online marketplace of posted loads, e.g. DAT, Truckstop.

**Lumper** — A third party paid to unload freight at a receiver.

**MC number** — FMCSA operating-authority docket number, still widely used in 2026.

**NOA** — Notice of assignment: tells brokers to pay a carrier's factoring company.

**Owner-operator** — A driver who owns his truck and often his own authority.

**POD** — Proof of delivery: the BOL signed by the receiver.

**Rate confirmation (RC)** — The broker–carrier agreement for one load: rate, stops, terms.

**RPM** — Rate per mile =  $\text{pay} \div \text{miles}$ .

**Shipper** — The company sending the freight.

**TONU** — Truck order not used: payment when a booked load is cancelled after the truck is dispatched, if the RC allows it.

**USDOT number** — FMCSA identifier for a company operating commercial vehicles; its safety record is tied to it.

# Sources and how facts were checked

Legal and numerical statements in this handbook were checked against official or primary sources in September 2026. Practitioner figures (dispatch fees, factoring fees, trucks per dispatcher) are marked as approximate and will be revisited in later modules.

| Publisher              | Document                                                                                                                                  | Where                                                                                                                                                                   |
|------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>FMCSA</b>           | Definitions of Broker and Bona Fide Agents — final guidance, Federal Register 2023-13080, 16 Jun 2023                                     | <a href="https://www.federalregister.gov/d/2023-13080">federalregister.gov/d/2023-13080</a>                                                                             |
| <b>eCFR</b>            | 49 CFR 371.2 (definitions: broker, bona fide agent); 49 CFR 387.307 (broker financial security)                                           | <a href="https://www.ecfr.gov">ecfr.gov</a>                                                                                                                             |
| <b>U.S. Code</b>       | 49 U.S.C. 14916 — Unlawful brokerage activities                                                                                           | <a href="https://www.law.cornell.edu/uscode/text/49/14916">law.cornell.edu/uscode/text/49/14916</a>                                                                     |
| <b>FMCSA</b>           | Broker and Carrier Fraud and Identity Theft                                                                                               | <a href="https://www.fmcsa.dot.gov/mission/help/broker-and-carrier-fraud-and-identity-theft">fmcsa.dot.gov/mission/help/broker-and-carrier-fraud-and-identity-theft</a> |
| <b>FMCSA</b>           | Changes to FMCSA Registrations in Motus                                                                                                   | <a href="https://www.fmcsa.dot.gov/registration/changes-fmcsa-registrations-motus">fmcsa.dot.gov/registration/changes-fmcsa-registrations-motus</a>                     |
| <b>DAT</b>             | Dispatch Load Board — carriers can add a seat for their dispatcher partner                                                                | <a href="https://www.dat.com/solutions/dispatch-load-board">dat.com/solutions/dispatch-load-board</a>                                                                   |
| <b>DAT</b>             | Truck Dispatcher License Requirements                                                                                                     | <a href="https://www.dat.com/solutions/truck-dispatcher-license">dat.com/solutions/truck-dispatcher-license</a>                                                         |
| <b>Truckstop</b>       | Carrier load board onboarding (MFA, security)                                                                                             | <a href="https://www.truckstop.com/resources/onboarding/load-board">truckstop.com/resources/onboarding/load-board</a>                                                   |
| <b>ATA</b>             | American Trucking Trends 2025 (2024 data: 11.27 bn tons, \$906 bn revenue, 3.58 m drivers, 91.5% of carriers ≤ 10 trucks)                 | <a href="https://www.trucking.org/news-insights/ata-american-trucking-trends-2025">trucking.org/news-insights/ata-american-trucking-trends-2025</a>                     |
| <b>U.S. DOT</b>        | Daylight Saving Time (rules and dates)                                                                                                    | <a href="https://www.transportation.gov/regulations/daylight-saving-time">transportation.gov/regulations/daylight-saving-time</a>                                       |
| <b>Indeed Pakistan</b> | Truck dispatcher job listings, Lahore and Pakistan-wide, viewed 30 Sep 2026                                                               | <a href="https://pk.indeed.com">pk.indeed.com</a>                                                                                                                       |
| <b>User-supplied</b>   | OMNITECH Training Manual (rate confirmation, BOL, POD, NOA, MC certificate, photos); Dry Van & Box Truck and Truck Types manuals (photos) | your files                                                                                                                                                              |



## Corrections to legacy training material in this module

Rates are not taught as fixed facts (Module 7). HOS is taught from FMCSA rules, not as “600 miles a day” (Module 4). Load-board codes follow current platform categories (Modules 2 and 6). Registration vocabulary reflects FMCSA’s 2025–26 Motus changes (Module 5).



## Time-sensitive content

Job ads, pay ranges, platform features and registration systems change. Items marked with a date (e.g. “Sep 2026”) should be re-checked when you use them.